A.T. ERIC NGO

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Department of Political Science
University of Iowa
Iowa City, Iowa, USA

EDUCATION

University of Iowa — **Iowa City, IA**
PhD, Political Science — *Expected May 2027*
MA, Political Science — *08/2021 – 12/2023*
Dissertation: *Webs of Power: How Networks of Elites Influence Foreign and Security Policy in Authoritarian Regimes*
Dissertation Committee: Brian Lai (co-chair), Sara Mitchell (co-chair), Frederick Solt, Qihang Lin, and Erica Frantz.

Truman State University, USA — **Kirksville, MO**
Bachelor of Science, Political Science & International Relations — *08/2017 – 05/2021*

Swedish Research School in Computational Social Science (SIRCSS), Linköping University — **Norrköping, Sweden**
Additional Training, Computational Approaches to Social Sciences — *06/2025 – 12/2026*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

International Relations: International Conflict, Foreign Policy, Domestic Politics of IR, Political Violence, Great Power Competition, Foreign Aid
Comparative Politics: Authoritarian Politics, Elite Politics, Political Institutions, Political Violence, Southeast Asia
Political Methodology: Statistics, Computational Social Science, Text-as-Data, Large Language Models, Network Analysis

PUBLICATIONS

Anh-Tu Ngo. 2026. "Us versus Them: Ethnic Inequality, Diversionary Nationalism, and International Conflict." *International Interactions*, 1–37. doi.org/10.1080/03050629.2026.2712372

Giao Nguyen, Uyen-Nhi Tran, My H. Nguyen, **Anh-Tu Ngo**, Thai Nguyen. 2026. "Nationalism, Patriotism, and Political Participation in Vietnam's Digital Sphere." *Journal of Information Technology and Politics.* doi.org/10.1080/19331681.2026.2745720

PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

Anh-Tu Ngo. "Racing for Influence: US-China Foreign Aid Competition and Recipient States' Domestic Politics." Under Review.
Anh-Tu Ngo. "Dictators at Sea: Economic Conditions of Autocracies and Militarization of Maritime Claims." Under Review.

WORKING PAPERS

Anh-Tu Ngo. "Fine-Tuning Open LLMs for Complex Information Extraction in Low-Resource Settings: Building Elite Networks from Biographies."

Anh-Tu Ngo. "Conflict, Network, and Survival: How Interstate and Intrastate Conflicts as well as Network Connections Influence Elite Tenure in Authoritarian Governments."

Anh-Tu Ngo. "Behind the Thrones: How Elite Networks Shape International Conflict Behavior of Autocracies."

Kirill Solosev, Franziska Keller, Yuequan Guo, **Anh-Tu Ngo**, Naim Bro, Seraphine Maerz, Kiril Melnikov, Qiange Liu, Felipe Perilla, Claire Fenwick. "Applications of LLMs in Studying Elite Networks".

Brian Lai, Adam Lappe, and **Anh-Tu Ngo**. "Rally Around Treaties: Arms Control and Presidential Approval."

Sara Mitchell, Elise Pizzi, **Anh-Tu Ngo**, and Ahmed Bulbul. "Political Crises, Electoral Violence, and Government Disaster Responses in Bangladesh."

ONGOING PROJECTS

Anh-Tu Ngo and Brian Lai. "How China Influences the Global South's AI Adoption Through Foreign Aid."

Anh-Tu Ngo. "Elite Networks and Repression in Authoritarian Regimes."

Anh-Tu Ngo and My H. Nguyen. "Local Elites and National Patrons: A LLM-Powered Database of Provincial Elites and Their Connections to Central Cabinet Elite Networks in Vietnam, 2000-2025."

Sara Mitchell, Elise Pizzi, and **Anh-Tu Ngo**. "LLM-Powered Systems for Data Collection of Political Actors in Natural Disasters."

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Disaster, Migration, and Violence (DMV) Lab, University of Iowa

Research Assistant *08/2026 – Present*

- Collaborating with Professors Sara Mitchell and Elise Pizzi to develop LLM-powered systems for collecting data on responses of political and governmental actors during natural disasters.
- Conducting a collaborative project to examine the link between elite networks at the central government and disaster response and violence in Vietnam, Cambodia, and Azerbaijan.

UNICEF Vietnam

Consultant & Instructor, AI Training Program *01/2026 – 02/2026*

- Designed and delivered an intensive and hands-on training program on artificial intelligence (AI) foundations, applications, and ethics for over 60 university-aged participants from diverse backgrounds.
- Provided consultation for UNICEF Vietnam's future directions for AI training sessions and learning materials.

Foreign Policy Analysis

Editorial Assistant & Replication Data Analyst *08/2023 – 05/2024*

- Conducted data analysis to inspect results of accepted peer-reviewed articles at FPA using Stata, R, and Python.
- Ensured timely communication between the authors and editorial team.

Advising System Improvement Project, Truman State University

Lead Consultant *08/2020 – 12/2020*

- Led a 3-person team of consultants to help Truman State's reforms in academic advising system by conducting a campus-wide survey and statistical analyses (in R) on students' advising experience.
- Delivered insights and policy recommendations via a presentation and 18-page report to Truman State authorities.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & INVITED TALKS

(*) invited talks for policy & practitioner audiences

Taureau AI, Hanoi, Vietnam (Scheduled)*	*01/2027*
American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Boston, MA	*09/2026*
ECPR Joint Sessions of Workshops, Using LLMs and AI Tools to Study Political Elite Networks, Innsbruck, Austria	*04/2026*
American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Vancouver, BC (Virtual Participation)	*09/2025*
WhoGov Workshop on Political Elites, University of Oslo, Oslo, Norway	*09/2025*
Development and Policy Research Center (DEPOCEN), Hanoi, Vietnam*	*06/2025*
International Studies Association Midwest (ISA-Midwest), St. Louis, MO	*11/2024*
Peace Science Society (International) 2024, Ann Arbor, MI	*11/2024*
Large Language Models (LLMs): Innerworkings, Applications and Ethics, Iowa City, IA	*10/2024*
American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA	*09/2024*
International Studies Association (ISA) Meeting, San Francisco, CA.	*04/2024*
International Studies Association Midwest (ISA-Midwest), St. Louis, MO	*11/2022*

HONORS, AWARDS, AND GRANTS

Awards & Fellowships

Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award ($1000), University of Iowa	*04/2025*
Post-Comprehensive Exam Research Fellowship ($11,000), Graduate College, University of Iowa	*02/2025*
Best Graduate Seminar Research Paper ($250), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa	*09/2024*
Iowa Recruitment Fellowship ($45,000), Graduate College, University of Iowa	*08/2021*
Grants-in-Aid of Scholarship and Research ($1500), Truman State University	*06/2020*
Truman State Presidential Scholarship ($36,000), Truman State University	*08/2017*

Grants

Travel Grant for ECPR Joint Sessions of Workshops ($1500), University of Bern and University of Graz	*04/2026*
Travel Grant ($300), Graduate and Professional Student Government, University of Iowa	*11/2025*
Travel Grant ($500), WhoGov Workshop on Political Elites, University of Oslo	*09/2025*
PolMeth Travel & Accommodation Grant ($700), Society for Political Methodology *(Declined)*	*07/2025*
Travel & Accommodation Grant ($6000), Swedish Research School in Computational Social Science	*06/2025*

TEACHING INTERESTS

Undergraduate Level:

Substantive: International Relations (IR), International Security, Foreign Policy, International Conflict, Political Violence, Authoritarian Politics, International Relations of Southeast Asia.

Methodology: Probability & Statistics, Research Design, Quantitative Methods, Social Data Analytics, Regression, Network Analysis, Time Series, AI and Society.

Graduate Level:

Substantive: International Relations (IR), International Conflict, Foreign Policy, Domestic Politics and IR, Political Violence.

Methodology: Computational Social Science, Text Analysis, Machine Learning, Large Language Models, Network Analysis, Probability and Statistics, Linear Regression, Limited Dependent Variable Regression, Time Series, Multilevel Models.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Workshop Instructor, UNICEF Vietnam
Foundations of Artificial Intelligence (AI): Mechanisms, Applications, and Socio-Ethical Considerations *Spring 2026*

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Iowa
Introduction to International Relations *Fall 2024, Spring 2022*
Introduction to American Foreign Relations *Spring 2024, Fall 2021*
Politics of International Economics *Fall 2023*
Consequences of War (virtual) *Spring 2023*
Introduction to Comparative Politics (virtual) *Spring 2023*
Introduction to Comparative Politics *Fall 2022*

SERVICE

Departmental and University

Graduate Student Representative, IR Faculty Recruitment Committee, UIowa Political Science Department *2024*
Co-Coordinator, International Relations (IR) Workshop Series, UIowa Political Science Department *2023 – 2024*
Graduate Student Peer Mentor, UIowa Political Science Department *2022 – Present*
President, Vietnamese Student Association (VSA), Truman State University *2019 – 2020*
Student Government Representative, Undergraduate Faculty Council, Truman State University *2018 – 2019*

Professional Service

Peer Reviewer, *Journal of Information Technology and Politics* *2026*
Peer Reviewer, *Foreign Policy Analysis* *2025*

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Methodological: Large Language Models (LLMs), Machine Learning, Text Analytics, Network Analysis, Statistics, Time Series Analysis, Generalized Linear Models, Multilevel Modelling

Computing: STATA, R, Python (Transformers, LangGraph, Llama, OpenAI, Scikit-learn, NLTK, spaCy), SPSS

Languages: Vietnamese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (elementary)